Otter Homecare

Staff Handbook (Your Daily Guide)

November 2026 Update

If something is not covered here, check the Access Policies & Procedures App or ask your manager.



How to use this handbook

This handbook is designed to be read and used day-to-day. It focuses on the questions we see most often in visits and in the office.

It is a quick guide. Full policies, procedures and detailed guidance are held in the Access Policies & Procedures App.

If you are unsure: stop, ask, and record what you did.

Golden rule

- Client safety and dignity come first.
- Be professional, kind and honest.
- Follow care plans and timekeeping rules.
- If in doubt, contact the office/manager.

Mission and values (KILT)

Our Mission: To consistently exceed expectations by delivering the highest quality home care across Somerset and Wiltshire.

Our Vision: We exist to make care kinder for those in need and those who care.

Our values (KILT) are not just words - we try to live them in every visit and every interaction in the office.

What this looks like in practice:

- **Kindness:** Be respectful, patient and calm - with clients, families and each other. Challenge issues kindly and privately.
- **Initiative:** Notice what needs doing and act on it, within your training and the client's care plan. If something could be safer, simpler or kinder, speak up. Do not do things a certain way just because it is how it has always been done.
- **Learning:** Ask when unsure. Use care plans. Accept feedback, reflect, and keep getting better.
- **Teamwork:** We are one team (carers and office). Communicate early, share information, and follow the same standards so everyone is treated fairly.



Values in action - quick self-check

Value	Examples you can point to (behaviours)
Kindness	Say hello, use names, speak respectfully. Explain PPE/time rules calmly. Give feedback privately. Support a colleague who is struggling (tell the office early).
Initiative	Suggest a better route/plan, raise repeated issues, share ideas in team meetings/WhatsApp, ask “Is there a safer or kinder way?”
Learning	Check the care plan before starting. Ask questions. Attend training. Report near-misses so we can improve. Keep records accurate and timely.
Teamwork	Handovers are clear. Messages are answered. Problems are logged and dealt with consistently. No favouritism - same process for everyone.

Non-negotiables (these protect clients and you)

Safeguarding - if you are worried

- If a client is at immediate risk: call emergency services first, then inform the office/manager as soon as possible.
- Report any concerns, changes, or inability to deliver care as planned.
- Do not promise secrecy. Do not investigate yourself. Record facts clearly.

Infection prevention and control

- Use PPE correctly when required for the task.
- Keep nails short and clean. No nail extensions for care delivery.
- Keep uniform clean and presentable.

Everyday standards - the common grey areas

This section is written to remove "grey areas" and reduce misunderstandings between carers and office staff.

A professional and friendly welcome

How you arrive and greet a client sets the tone for the entire visit. A warm, professional welcome makes clients feel valued and builds trust.

- Smile when you greet the client – even if you're tired or having a difficult day.
- Ask how they are doing. Take a moment to listen to their answer. This shows genuine care.
- Use the client's preferred name (check their care plan if you're unsure).
- Be calm and unhurried in your manner, even if you're running close on time.

Remember: for many clients, you may be the only person they see that day. Your warmth and kindness matter enormously.

PPE - what we expect

PPE is not optional where the task (or care plan) requires it. It protects clients and you, and it protects the company's reputation.

Use this as your quick decision guide:

- If there is any chance of contact with bodily fluids: wear gloves and a disposable apron.
- Change gloves/apron between tasks when moving from "dirty" to "clean" (e.g., continence care then meal prep and then medication administration).
- Always perform hand hygiene before and after PPE use (gloves are not a substitute for hand hygiene).
- If PPE is missing or you are unsure what to use: stop, contact the office, and record what happened.
- If a client asks you not to use PPE, explain kindly that it is required for safety, then contact the office if the client continues to refuse.

Masks (where required):

- If you have symptoms of a respiratory infection, follow the Absence Management / Infection Control guidance and inform the office.

Use PPE according to the task and the care plan. If you are unsure, ask the office before the visit where possible.

PPE: quick guide

Do	Don't
• Wear gloves and apron for personal care tasks where there is contact with bodily fluids or intimate care. • Dispose of PPE safely after use and	• Do not reuse single-use PPE. • Do not skip PPE because you are "in a hurry". • Do not wear gloves as a substitute for

perform hand hygiene. • Replace PPE between clients and between tasks where needed. • If PPE supplies are low: inform the office immediately.	hand hygiene.

What good looks like: PPE example

Sarah arrived at Mrs Jenkins' home for morning personal care and noticed she was running very low on gloves in her supply bag. Rather than trying to stretch what she had, she immediately informed the office after the visit and arranged to collect more supplies that afternoon. This meant her next visits had proper PPE available and there was no risk of having to skip necessary protection.

Nails, jewellery and appearance

These standards exist for infection control, safety, and professionalism. If in doubt, ask before your shift.

- Hair: keep long hair tied back during care tasks.
- Footwear: closed-toe, non-slip, and safe for moving/handling tasks (no slippers in visits).
- Perfume/aftershave: keep to a minimum (many clients are sensitive).
- ID: wear your ID badge/lanyard as required and keep it visible where appropriate.

To keep clients safe and reduce infection risk, we set clear standards.

- Nails
    - Must be short, clean, and not extend beyond the fingertip.
    - No acrylics, gels, or nail extensions while delivering care.
    - If you are unsure whether your nails meet the standard, ask before your shift.
- Jewellery
    - Keep jewellery minimal for safety and hygiene (e.g., plain ring).
    - Remove items that could scratch clients or interfere with gloves.
    - Remove watches during personal care tasks (they harbour bacteria and interfere with proper hand hygiene).

Dress code in visits (including coats)

The rule of thumb: once you are in a client's home, you should look like a care professional (clean, prepared, and safe).

The Otter Homecare uniform is the company issued Otter Teal Green polo shirt with black or dark trousers and dark, covered shoes.

If a home is very cold:

- Use a clean indoor layer (e.g. jumper/fleece/cardigan) rather than an outdoor coat.
- Sleeves should be bare to help with IPC – bare skin can be washed far more easily than fabric.
- If an exception is needed, contact the office and record the reason (and any client agreement).
- Never let extra layers interfere with hygiene (e.g., sleeves dragging in water/food) or with personal care tasks.

Clients should experience a professional, clean, and safe approach in their home.

Coats/outer layers in a visit

Do	Don't
• Remove outdoor coats on arrival where practical. • If a home is very cold and an extra layer is needed for health/safety, inform the office and record the reason. • Use a clean indoor layer (e.g., uniform fleece) if provided/approved.	• Do not deliver personal care wearing an outdoor coat. • Do not keep a coat on for convenience if it affects hygiene or professionalism. • Do not apply different standards for different staff.

Reporting absence (inability to work)

If you are unable to work due to illness or emergency, you must report this as soon as possible so we can arrange cover for clients.

How to report absence:

- **Always call the on-call phone** – do not text. Calling ensures we can respond quickly and arrange cover.
- **Do not call between 10pm and 5am** unless it is a genuine emergency. If you are on an early shift, call from 5am so there is time to cover your visits.
- **Outside of 10pm–5am:** Call the on-call phone immediately to alert us of your inability to work.

What happens next:

- In most cases, the on-call/office will remove all work from your schedule until you come in for a back-to-work interview.
- You will need to be signed off as fit to work again before returning to your duties.
- This process protects both you and the clients we serve.

Absence monitoring (Bradford Factor):
We use the Bradford Factor to monitor absences. The Bradford Factor measures the impact of short-term absences on the business, with frequent short absences scoring higher than single longer absences.

Please be aware that if your Bradford Factor reaches a high level, it will be taken into account when reviewing your performance, probation status, and suitability for continued employment.

This is not designed to penalise genuine illness, but to ensure fairness and consistency across the team, and to minimise disruption to client care.

Full details can be found in the Absence Management policy in the Access Policies & Procedures App.

Timekeeping during visits

Being on time is part of safe, dignified care. We also need accurate records for clients, families and commissioning.

Timekeeping rules (to remove grey areas):

- Arrive ready to start at the scheduled time (allow travel/parking time).
- Do not start more than 15 minutes early unless the care plan allows it or the office authorises it.
- If you expect to be more than 15 minutes late: call the client as soon as you know. If unable to contact the client, call / inform the office
- Never shorten a visit to "catch up" without the office agreeing and recording the change.
- If a client asks you to change times, the office must agree the change (so it can be recorded and communicated).

If a visit cannot be delivered as planned:

- Contact the office immediately.
- Follow instructions (re-route, extend/adjust another carer, inform family where appropriate).
- Record the facts and actions taken (no blame language, just what happened).

If you will be late

- Tell the office as soon as you know (do not wait until the visit start time).
- Follow instructions from the office on what to do next (re-route, inform family, etc.).
- Record the reason and the actions taken.

If you arrive early

- Do not start early unless the care plan/client agreement allows it or the office authorises it.
- If a client asks you to start early, contact the office so the change can be agreed and recorded.

What good looks like: timekeeping example

Jo's car broke down en route to a visit. He immediately called the on-call phone at 7:15am, explained the situation clearly ("My car won't start, I'm due at Mrs Davies at 7:30am"), and stayed by his phone. The office arranged emergency cover. Jo's prompt communication meant the client received care on time and there was no confusion.

Recording and honesty

Accurate records protect clients and staff.

- Record visits and tasks as you complete them.
- If you could not complete something, record why and tell the office.
- Never record times or tasks that did not happen.

Common boundary questions (quick answers)

Use your common sense and initiative. If you are asked to do something unusual or outside the care plan, it is helpful to contact the office for guidance.

- Money and shopping: only handle client money if the care plan says so and you follow the agreed process.
- Gifts: do not accept significant gifts, and do not lend/borrow money. If a client insists on giving a gift, tell the office.
- Visitors in a client's home: do not bring any other person into a client's home.
- Extra domestic jobs (gardening, DIY, personal errands): check with the office first - professional boundaries apply.

Fair and consistent handling of issues

We do this to protect clients, protect staff, and remove any perception of favouritism.

How an issue is handled (same steps for everyone):

- 1) Record the concern (what happened, when, where) and keep it factual.
- 2) Gather evidence where available (care app records, call logs, spot check notes, client feedback).
- 3) Manager reviews and decides: coaching/support, formal action, or urgent escalation.
- 4) Outcome is recorded and shared appropriately (including any learning or expectations).
- 5) Review date set if an exception or support plan is agreed.

To prevent misunderstandings and accusations of favouritism, we use the same process for everyone.

What this means in practice

- Concerns are logged and reviewed using evidence (care records, call logs, supervision notes).
- Any exception to a standard must be agreed and recorded with a reason and review date.
- Coaching and support are considered where appropriate, but repeated breaches are escalated.

Discipline pathway (summary)

The manager will consider the facts, risk to the client, and whether this is repeated behaviour. Full process and appeal rights are in the Access Policies & Procedures App.

Examples (guidance only - depends on circumstances):

- Coaching / reminder: first-time minor uniform issue; minor documentation mistake corrected promptly; one-off lateness with good communication.
- Formal warning: repeated lateness; repeated PPE non-compliance; leaving visits early without agreement; repeated failure to follow instructions.
- Likely to escalate quickly: dishonesty (times/tasks that did not happen); serious infection control breach; behaviour that puts a client at risk; safeguarding concerns.

Most issues follow this pathway (the full Disciplinary Policy is in the Access app):

1. Step 1: Informal conversation / coaching (for first-time, low-risk issues).
2. Step 2: Formal warning (if repeated or if the issue is more serious).
3. Step 3: Final warning (if repeated again or serious).
4. Step 4: Dismissal (for repeated serious issues or gross misconduct).

Examples of issues that may be escalated quickly:

- Serious infection control breaches that put clients at risk.
- Dishonesty in records (times/tasks).
- Safeguarding concerns or behaviour that endangers a client.

Using your initiative and seeking help

You are with the client and often in the best position to make a decision about what to do. We trust you to use your common sense and initiative, especially when it comes to seeking external medical help or advice.

When to act without calling the office first

- **If it is a genuine emergency:** call 999 straight away. Do not call the office first – every second counts. Inform the office as soon as possible after calling 999.
- **For non-emergency medical advice:** you can call 111 (NHS non-emergency line) if you are concerned about the client's health but it is not an emergency.
- **For clients with a district nurse:** if the client receives regular support from a district nurse and you have concerns about wound care, pressure areas, or other nursing matters, you can contact the district nurse directly. The contact details should be in the client's care plan or visible in the home.

After seeking external help

Always inform the office as soon as possible after calling 999, 111, or the district nurse. Record what happened, who you contacted, and what advice or action was taken.

When you should call the office

For non-medical issues (e.g., client refuses care, visit running late, PPE missing, care plan unclear), contact the office/on-call as your first point of contact.

The Mental Capacity Act – Your Friend in Care

The Mental Capacity Act (MCA) is not about rules and restrictions – it's a practical tool that helps you provide better care. Think of it as a friend that guides you through complex situations, helps you know when to accept a "no" and when you can encourage further, and gives you confidence to make the right decisions.

The Five Key Principles

5. **Assume capacity:** Always start by assuming someone can make their own decisions unless you have a good reason to think otherwise.
6. **Support decision-making:** Help people make decisions before you conclude they can't. Try different times, break tasks down, use simpler words, or offer alternatives.

7. **Unwise decisions are allowed:** People can make choices you disagree with – that doesn't mean they lack capacity.
8. **Best interests:** If someone genuinely can't make a specific decision, any action taken must be in their best interests.
9. **Least restrictive:** Always choose the option that restricts the person's freedom and rights the least.

In Practice: What This Means for You

- **Don't give up after the first "no":** If someone refuses care, gently explore why. Could you try again later? Break the task into smaller steps? Offer choices? The MCA empowers you to keep trying in a respectful way.
- **But never force:** If someone becomes distressed or continues to refuse clearly, stop. The MCA protects their right to say no.
- **When capacity is unclear:** If you're genuinely unsure whether someone understands the consequences of refusing essential care, contact the office. We can assess capacity properly and make best interest decisions if needed.
- **Capacity can change:** Someone might lack capacity first thing in the morning but have it later. Someone might have capacity for small decisions but not complex ones. This is normal.

The MCA gives you confidence to do the right thing. You're not just "giving up" when you accept a refusal, and you're not "being pushy" when you try again – you're following a legal framework designed to protect dignity while ensuring safety. Your MCA training during induction covers this in detail, and we're always here to support you with difficult decisions.

When a client refuses care or you feel unsafe

Client refusal of care and personal safety are serious issues. This section gives you clear steps to follow.

If a client refuses care

- Stay calm and respectful. Never show frustration or impatience.
- Try to understand the reason. Are they in pain, tired, afraid, or confused? Sometimes just asking "What's worrying you?" helps.
- Explain gently why the care is important, but never force, coerce, or pressure the client.
- If the refusal continues: contact the on-call/office immediately. Do not leave without informing the office.
- Record exactly what happened, what was said, the time, and what care was not delivered.

If you feel unsafe

Your safety is paramount. Trust your instincts.

- If a client becomes threatening, aggressive, or you feel unsafe: remove yourself from the situation immediately.
- Call emergency services (999) if there is an immediate threat to you or the client.
- Contact the on-call/office immediately after leaving or as soon as it is safe to do so.
- Do not return to the visit without management approval and a safety plan in place.
- Record what happened as soon as possible – facts only, no assumptions.

Medication administration

Before administering any medication, you must always follow the 6 Rights of Medication Administration:

1. **Right person** – ensure the medication is for the correct client
2. **Right medication** – check the medication name carefully
3. **Right dose** – never guess; check the label and care plan
4. **Right time** – administer at the correct time and frequency
5. **Right route** – e.g. oral, topical, eye drops, inhaler
6. **Right documentation** – record immediately after administration or refusal

General rules

- Only administer medication if:
    - you have been trained and assessed as competent, and
    - the medication is clearly specified in the client's care plan and MAR.
- Never guess dosages, timings, or instructions. Check the care plan and pharmacy label every time.
- Never administer any medication, cream, ointment, eye drops or topical treatment without a pharmacy label.
    - If the label is missing, damaged, or illegible: do not administer and contact the office immediately.
- If a client asks you to give medication not listed in the care plan (including over-the-counter items): politely decline and inform the office immediately.
- If a client refuses medication:
    - do not force or coerce,
    - record the refusal immediately in the care app,
    - inform the office or on-call manager.
- All medication given or refused must be recorded immediately in the care app.

    - Medication records are legal documents. Never delay or back-date entries.
- If you make a medication error (wrong dose, wrong time, missed dose, or incorrect medication):
    - inform the office immediately,
    - follow instructions given,
    - record the incident accurately in the care app.
    - Do not wait until the end of your shift.

Raising concerns (whistleblowing and speaking up)

We want to hear from you if something is wrong. Genuine concerns raised in good faith are protected, and you will not be penalised for speaking up.

When to raise a concern

Speak up if you:

- Witness unsafe practice or poor care (by a colleague, manager, or anyone else).
- Suspect safeguarding issues, abuse, or neglect.
- Are concerned about how a decision has been made or how you have been treated.
- Believe something unlawful is happening (fraud, breaches of regulations, health and safety risks).

Who to speak to

- **First step:** Speak to your line manager or the Registered Manager. Most concerns can be resolved quickly this way.
- **If your concern is about your manager:** Speak to a Director or use the Grievance Policy (in the Access app).
- **If you believe nothing is being done:** You can contact the Care Quality Commission (CQC) or the local authority safeguarding team. Contact details are in the Access app.

Full details are in the Whistleblowing Policy in the Access Policies & Procedures App.

Social media, photos and professional conduct online

What you post online can affect client safety, your employment, and Otter's reputation. Be professional at all times.

Photos and videos – strict rules

- **Never** take photos or videos of clients, their homes, personal information, or care records.

- If a client or family member asks you to take a photo with them: politely decline and explain this is company policy to protect everyone's privacy.
- **Exception:** Photos or videos may only be taken if: (a) explicitly approved by management for training, safeguarding documentation, or business purposes, or (b) the client has given written consent and you send the photos directly to the office (not posted online or kept on your personal device). Always check with the office before taking any photos or videos.

What you can and cannot post on social media

- **Never** post about specific clients, visits, or anything that could identify a client (even without naming them).
- **Never** make negative, derogatory, or unprofessional comments about Otter Homecare, colleagues, clients, or the care sector.
- You can mention that you work for Otter Homecare on your personal social media (e.g., on LinkedIn or in your bio), but keep all posts professional.
- If you wouldn't say it in front of a client or their family, don't post it online.

What brings the company into disrepute

Bringing the company into disrepute means any behaviour (online or offline) that damages Otter's reputation, client trust, or staff morale. Examples include:

- Public complaints or criticism of the company on social media.
- Posting content that is offensive, discriminatory, or unprofessional while identifying yourself as an Otter employee.
- Sharing confidential company information, client details, or internal discussions publicly.

If you have concerns about the company, use the Grievance or Whistleblowing Policy. Posting online is not the right route.

Support and Reflection Sessions

We hold quarterly Support & Reflection Sessions with each team member. These are supportive, values-based conversations – not traditional tick-box supervisions. Each quarter focuses on one of our KILT values (Kindness, Initiative, Learning, Teamwork). You choose the format (office, café, or online), sessions are typically 30-45 minutes, and Care Professionals are paid for the hour. These sessions are about support first, performance second – they are not about catching you out, but about making sure you feel valued and connected to the wider Otter team.

Where to find the full detail (policy index)

Use this page when you need the full policy wording. Search these titles in the Access Policies & Procedures App.

Policy	Use it for
Safeguarding Adults	What to do if you suspect abuse or neglect; reporting routes.
Infection Prevention and Control / PPE	PPE requirements, hand hygiene, disposal.
Dress Code & Uniform	Uniform standards, appearance, acceptable clothing.
Absence Management	Reporting sickness/absence, return to work.
Disciplinary Policy	Formal process, meetings, appeals.
Grievance Policy	Raising concerns about treatment or decisions.
Medication Administration	Training requirements, safe administration, recording, error reporting.
Whistleblowing Policy	Raising concerns in good faith, protection from retaliation, external contacts.
Social Media Policy	Professional conduct online.

Appendix - rare but important

These topics are important but less likely to come up day-to-day. If you need detail, check the full policies in Access or ask your manager.

- Confidentiality and information handling
- Rights of search (on premises / while conducting business)
- Communications to the media
- Notice periods and leaving the organisation

Contractual Appendix (forms part of your contract)

This Contractual Appendix forms part of your contract of employment with Otter Homecare Limited. All other sections of this Practical Staff Handbook are provided as guidance only, do not form part of your contract (unless expressly stated), and may be amended from time to time.

If there is any conflict between (1) your Contract of Employment/Statement of Particulars and (2) this Contractual Appendix, the Contract of Employment/Statement of Particulars will take precedence.

Confidentiality, data and return of property

During and after your employment you must keep confidential all trade secrets and any information of a confidential nature relating to the Company, its clients/service users, staff, suppliers and business affairs, except where disclosure is required in the proper course of your duties or by law.

- You must not remove Company documents, records or items containing confidential information from Company premises or systems without prior authorisation.
- You must return all Company property and all documents/records on request and in any event on termination (including uniform, keys, ID badges/lanyards, phones, IT equipment, documents and records).
- If requested, you must delete confidential information from any reusable material and securely destroy any copies under your control.

Right of search

The Company may carry out reasonable searches of employees and their property (including bags and vehicles) while they are on Company premises or conducting business on the Company's behalf. Searches may be random and do not imply suspicion.

- Where practicable, you may be accompanied by a colleague who is present at the time.
- You may be asked to empty pockets and open bags/vehicles/lockers (where applicable) as part of the search.
- Unreasonable refusal to cooperate will constitute a breach of contract, which could result in disciplinary action up to and including dismissal. The Company reserves the right to involve the police at any stage.

Communications to the media

Only the Directors (or a person they authorise in writing) may make statements to the media or on behalf of the Company. If you receive an enquiry from the media, you must refer it to the office immediately and must not comment.

Changes to this appendix

The Company may amend this Contractual Appendix from time to time to reflect legal, regulatory or business changes. Where required, changes will be implemented following consultation.

Confirmation of employment and statement of terms

You will receive your Statement of Main Terms and Conditions (your contract) to sign before your first day. That Statement, together with this Contractual Appendix, covers all of the conditions of employment applicable to you. If there is any conflict, the Statement of Main Terms and Conditions will take precedence.

Private work for clients

Private work for clients with whom Otter Homecare is already providing care is not permitted, as it conflicts with your contract of employment and may constitute financial abuse. In exceptional circumstances, the Company may authorise such work where it is clearly for the benefit of the client, subject to the approval of the organisation or individual funding the care, subject to controls on charging and quality, and with prior written agreement from the Registered Manager.

Using your own car for work

You are not insured by the Company when using your own vehicle during working hours. If you use your own car for work purposes you must hold the correct level of motor insurance:

- Travelling to a permanent workplace only: Social and Commuting, Comprehensive.
- Travelling to different workplaces (then onward by other means): Business Class 1, Comprehensive.
- Travelling between clients by car: Business Class 2, Comprehensive.
- Carrying clients in your car: Business Class 3, Comprehensive (and you must confirm cover directly with your insurer).

You must be able to provide proof of appropriate insurance cover and a valid driving licence. Any change in either must be reported to the Company immediately. If a client asks you to take them somewhere in your own vehicle, you must refuse unless you hold the appropriate cover.

Conduct outside working hours

We have no wish to intrude upon your activities outside work. However, any activity outside working hours that results in adverse publicity to the business, brings the Company into disrepute, causes us to question your integrity, or has a detrimental impact upon relations with colleagues or clients may result in disciplinary action up to and including dismissal, depending on the seriousness of the conduct and its impact on the organisation.

Training obligations

All employees are entitled to a minimum of three days' paid training per year, which includes in-house training, staff meetings and supervisions. You must complete induction training and all mandatory training as required. Failure to attend mandatory training may result in disciplinary action. You are employed subject to certain contractual requirements regarding training and qualifications as detailed in your Statement of Terms and Conditions, in order for the Company to satisfy its obligations under the Health and Social Care Act 2008 (as amended).

Holiday entitlement

The annual leave year runs from 1 April to 31 March. Full-time staff are entitled to 5.6 weeks (28 days) per year. Part-time and casual staff entitlements are calculated pro-rata in line with the terms of your contract. Public/bank holiday pay arrangements are set out in your Statement of Terms and Conditions. Full details are in the Annual Leave policy in the Access Policies & Procedures App.

Notice periods and leaving the organisation

The notice period you are required to give is set out in your individual terms and conditions of employment. You are required to work cooperatively and to full capacity during your notice period unless the Company agrees otherwise or requests you to cease work early.

If you leave without giving or working the required notice period, the following is an express written term of your contract:

- An amount equal to any additional cost of covering your duties during the unworked notice period will be deducted from any termination pay due to you.
- You will also forfeit any contractually accrued holiday pay over and above your statutory holiday pay.

Additional costs include: covering shifts by someone on a higher hourly rate, agency worker costs, and administrative costs incurred in arranging urgent cover. This right does not limit any other legal rights or remedies the Company may have. An unjustified failure to work notice may be referred to in any reference provided to prospective employers.

Equal opportunities and non-harassment

The Company is committed to equality of opportunity and to providing a working environment free from harassment and bullying. Any breach of the Equality and Diversity Policy or the Bullying and Harassment Policy (both available in the Access Policies & Procedures App) may lead to disciplinary action, which may include dismissal. In all situations, people will be judged solely on merit or ability.

Summary of our rights to deduct

You authorise the Company to deduct from your wages, expenses, holiday pay, final pay and/or any other sums due to you (to the extent permitted by law) the following amounts where they arise:

- Any overpayment of wages, holiday pay, expenses, mileage, allowances or other payments made to you in error.
- Any payment made to you in respect of holiday taken but not accrued at the date your employment ends (including as set out in your Statement of Particulars).
- The cost (or a reasonable proportion of the cost) of repairing or replacing Company property, client property, vehicles, stock or equipment that is lost, damaged or wasted due to your carelessness, negligence, breach of rules/procedures, or deliberate act.
- Any insurance excess and/or related costs payable where loss/damage arises due to your carelessness or negligence.
- The value of any Company property not returned when requested or on termination.

Where practicable, the Company will discuss a proposed deduction with you in advance and provide details on your payslip or in writing. This does not limit the Company's right to recover sums by other lawful means.